

A PROVEN STRATEGY TO MAXIMISE YOUR SALE PRICE

Harcourts Cooper & Co

Preparation. Positioning. Premium Results.



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WHY PREPARATION DRIVES PREMIUM SALE PRICES

The difference between an average result and a premium sale price is not luck - it is preparation and positioning.

Most buyers form an emotional connection within moments of seeing a home.

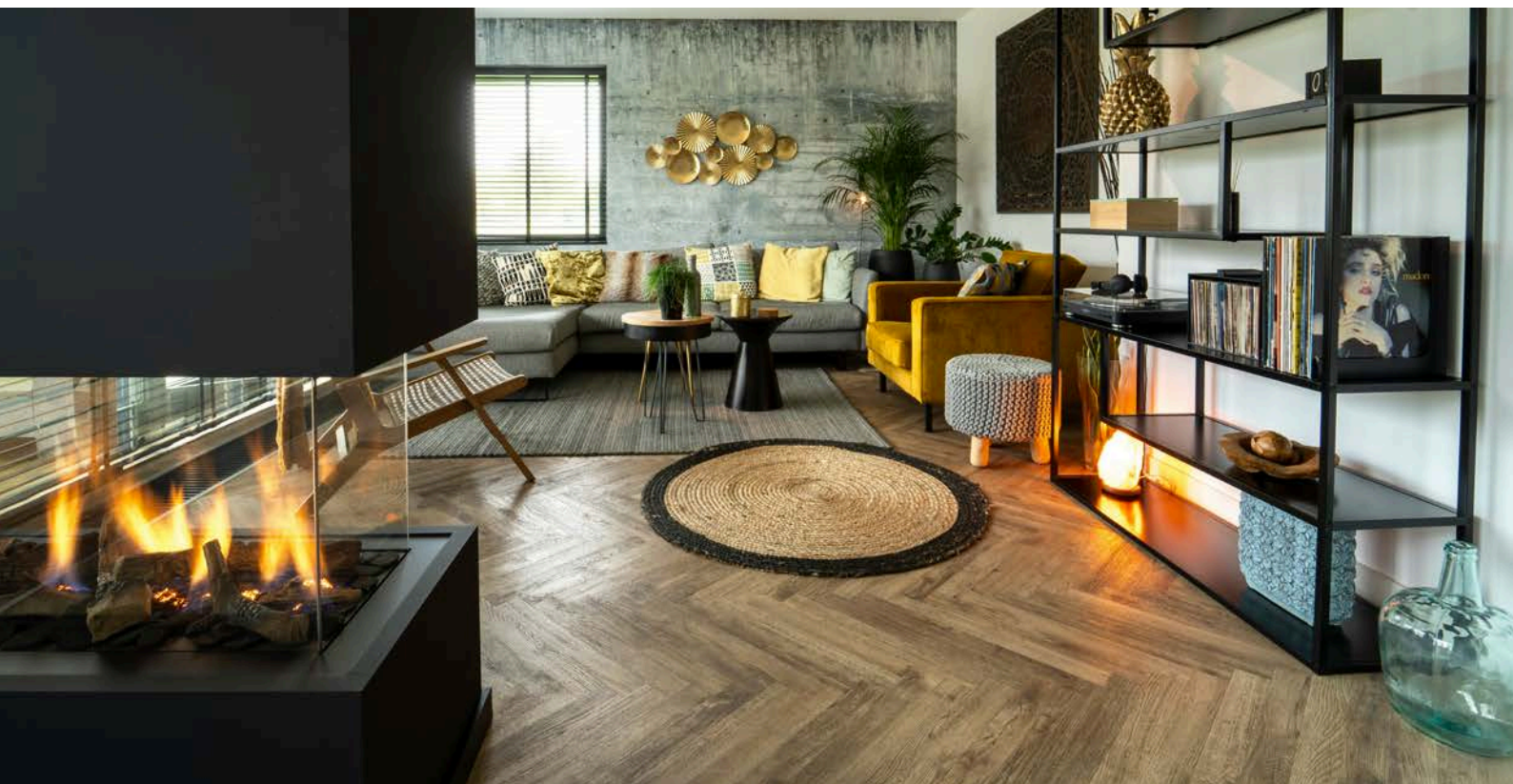
When that connection is strong, multiple buyers are drawn to the same property. That is what creates competition. And competition is what ultimately drives premium sale prices.

The role of preparation is simple — but critical:

To ensure your home appeals to the widest possible pool of buyers and stands out against competing properties.

When this is done correctly, the result is not just more interest — but stronger offers and better outcomes.

“This is where sellers either gain or lose tens of thousands of dollars.”

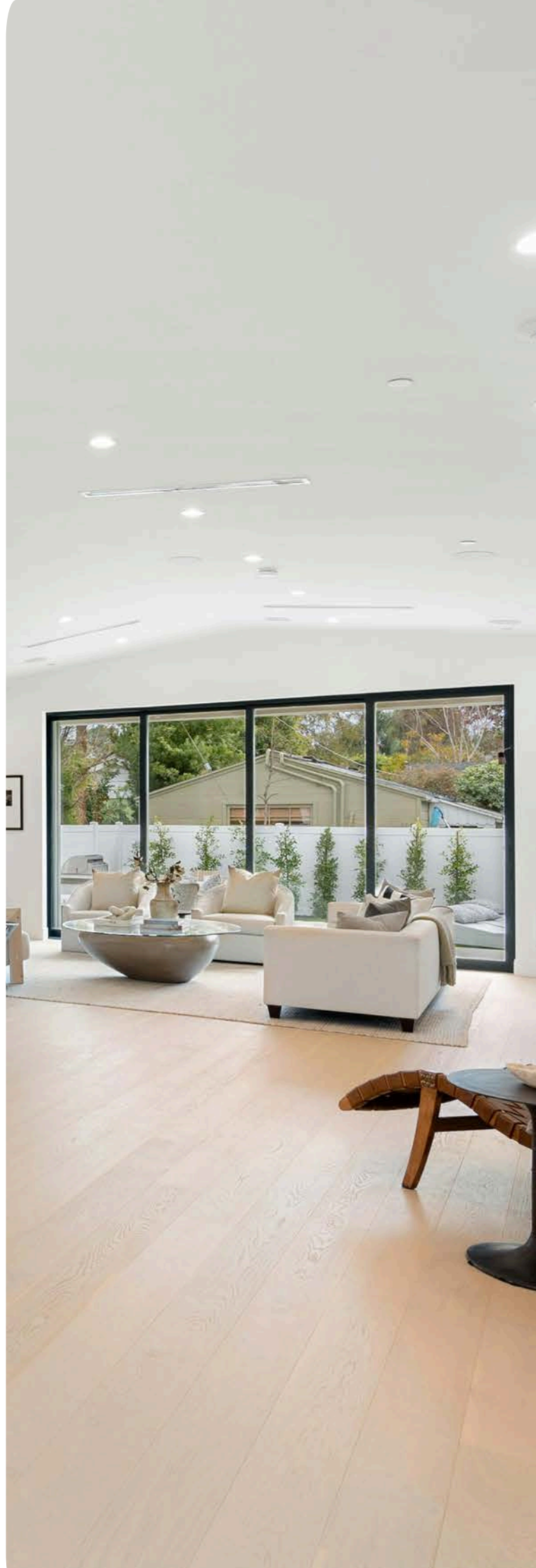


HOW BUYERS ACTUALLY DECIDE

Understanding this is the key to achieving a premium result.

- Buyers decide emotionally first
- Justify logically later
- Compare everything instantly online
- Eliminate homes quickly

This is why presentation and positioning are not optional — they are what determine how buyers feel about your home, and ultimately what they are willing to pay.



FIRST IMPRESSIONS MATTER

Buyers begin forming an opinion about your home before they even step inside.

A well-presented exterior signals that the property has been maintained and cared for.

This builds confidence and encourages buyers to view the rest of the home more positively.

Simple improvements such as mowing lawns, tidying gardens, trimming hedges, and adding fresh plants or mulch can dramatically improve how your home is perceived.

A welcoming entrance sets the tone for the entire viewing experience.

Simple Improvements That Make a Difference

- Mow and edge lawns
- Trim hedges and shrubs
- Remove weeds and garden clutter
- Add fresh plants or flowers
- Spread mulch around garden beds
- Ensure pathways and entry areas are tidy



SPACE SELLS!

Space is one of the most valuable features buyers look for — and one of the easiest to lose through poor presentation.

Clutter reduces the sense of space in a home and distracts buyers from the property itself. When spaces are clean, open, and well laid out, rooms feel larger, brighter, and more functional.

This allows buyers to clearly imagine how they would live in the home, which is a critical step toward making an offer. Well-presented storage areas also send a powerful signal. When wardrobes, cupboards, and cabinets feel spacious and organised, buyers assume the home offers strong storage overall.

Simple Ways to Create More Space

- Remove excess furniture
- Clear kitchen benches and surfaces
- Pack away personal items and photographs
- Store seasonal or unused belongings
- Keep wardrobes and cupboards half full
- Organise storage areas neatly

“If a space feels small, buyers assume the home is small.”





**“If buyers can’t
imagine themselves
living there, they
won’t buy it.”**

CLEAN HOMES FEEL MORE VALUABLE

Cleanliness has a direct impact on how buyers perceive value.

When a home feels spotless and well-cared-for, buyers assume it has been properly maintained. This increases confidence and makes them more comfortable moving forward.

Small details matter more than most sellers expect. Clean windows, fresh bathrooms, and tidy kitchen spaces all contribute to how a home is judged.

A well-presented home not only shows better in person — it also performs better in marketing, attracting more attention and more buyers.

High-Impact Cleaning Areas

- Steam clean carpets and rugs
- Clean windows and window frames
- Deep clean bathrooms and showers
- Degrease ovens and kitchen surfaces
- Clean fireplaces and heating units
- Water blast decks, patios, and outdoor areas
- Clear clutter from kitchen benches



STAGING DRIVES PREMIUM PRICES

Staged homes consistently outperform unstaged homes. This is one of the highest ROI decisions a seller can make

Professional staging enhances how a home is perceived by buyers.

Well-chosen furniture, layout, and styling highlight the property's strengths and create a warm, inviting atmosphere.

This allows buyers to clearly imagine how they would live in the home, which is a key step toward making an offer.

Staged homes also photograph significantly better, attracting more online attention and bringing more buyers through the door.

More buyers create more competition, and competition is what drives premium sale prices.

We partner with leading staging companies and help you decide when staging will deliver the best return.



NOT ALL IMPROVEMENTS ADD VALUE

Not every improvement increases your sale price — and some can actually reduce your return

Buyers respond most strongly to homes that feel fresh, well-maintained, and move-in ready. Simple improvements often deliver the highest return, particularly those that improve how the home looks and feels.

In contrast, expensive upgrades such as new appliances or furniture rarely return their full cost. Buyers prefer to make these choices themselves and may not value them equally

The goal is not to over-invest, but to invest where it has the greatest impact on buyer perception.

High-Return Improvements

- Replace badly worn or stained carpets
- Refresh interior paint where needed
- Repair small visible defects
- Ensure flooring and surfaces feel well-maintained
- Avoid expensive renovations immediately before selling

“Buyers pay for what they see — not what you’ve spent”



LIGHT CREATES EMOTION

Light and colour have a powerful influence on how buyers feel when they walk through a home.

Bright, well-lit spaces feel larger, cleaner, and more inviting. Natural light enhances the overall atmosphere and helps buyers connect emotionally with the home.

Simple changes — such as refreshing tired paint, improving lighting, or using neutral tones — can significantly improve how a property presents both in person and online.

Buyers are naturally drawn to homes that feel light, fresh, and easy to live in.

Simple Changes That Make a Big Impact

- Refresh interior paint where needed
- Use light, neutral colours
- Replace dim or mismatched light bulbs
- Ensure all rooms are well lit
- Update small items such as shower curtains or bathroom accessories
- Check that lighting fixtures are clean and working

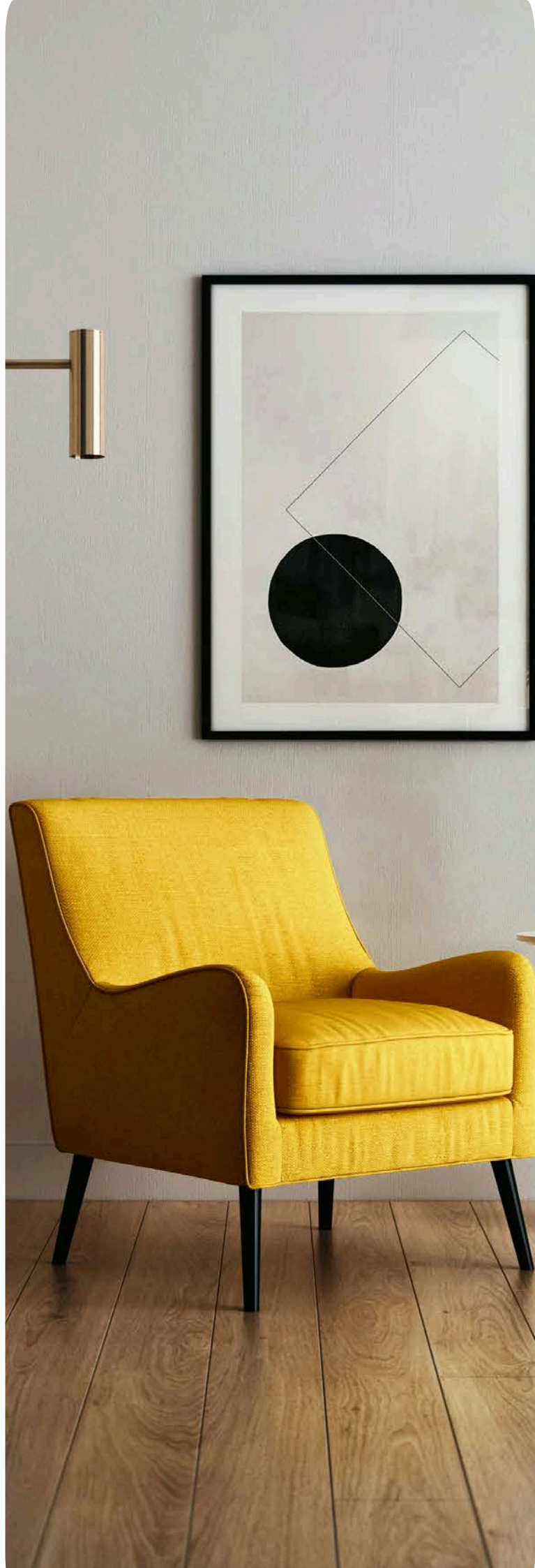


THE DETAILS THAT KILL DEALS

Common Issues That Turn Buyers Off

- Replace worn or outdated toilet seats
- Ensure bathrooms feel fresh and tidy
- Clean or repair driveway surfaces
- Clear gutters and downpipes
- Check exterior paths and entry areas
- Remove visible maintenance issues

Buyers often judge how well a home has been maintained by the small details they notice.



REMOVE DOUBT. INCREASE CONFIDENCE.

Buyer confidence is one of the most important factors in achieving a strong sale price.

Even small issues can create disproportionate doubt in a buyer's mind.

When buyers notice minor defects, they often assume there may be larger hidden problems. This can reduce confidence, impact offers, or cause buyers to walk away altogether.

Addressing these issues before going to market helps present the home as well-maintained and removes unnecessary risk from the buying decision.

When buyers feel confident, they focus on the home's strengths rather than potential problems.

Important Areas to Check

- Structural or major defects
- Roof leaks or flashing issues
- Safety concerns or electrical hazards
- Maintenance items affecting finance or insurance
- Small visible defects such as dripping taps or damaged fittings



CREATE AN EMOTIONAL CONNECTION

Buyers respond emotionally before they justify their decision logically.

A home that feels welcoming, warm, and well presented allows buyers to picture their future there. Natural light, fresh air, and clean, open spaces create an atmosphere that invites buyers to stay longer and explore.

When multiple buyers feel that same connection, competition naturally increases.

And competition is what ultimately drives premium sale prices.

Buyers often decide how they feel about a home within the first few minutes of entering.



THE VIEWING EXPERIENCE MATTERS

The way your home feels during inspections directly impacts buyer interest.

A bright, comfortable, and welcoming environment encourages buyers to slow down, explore, and imagine living in the home.

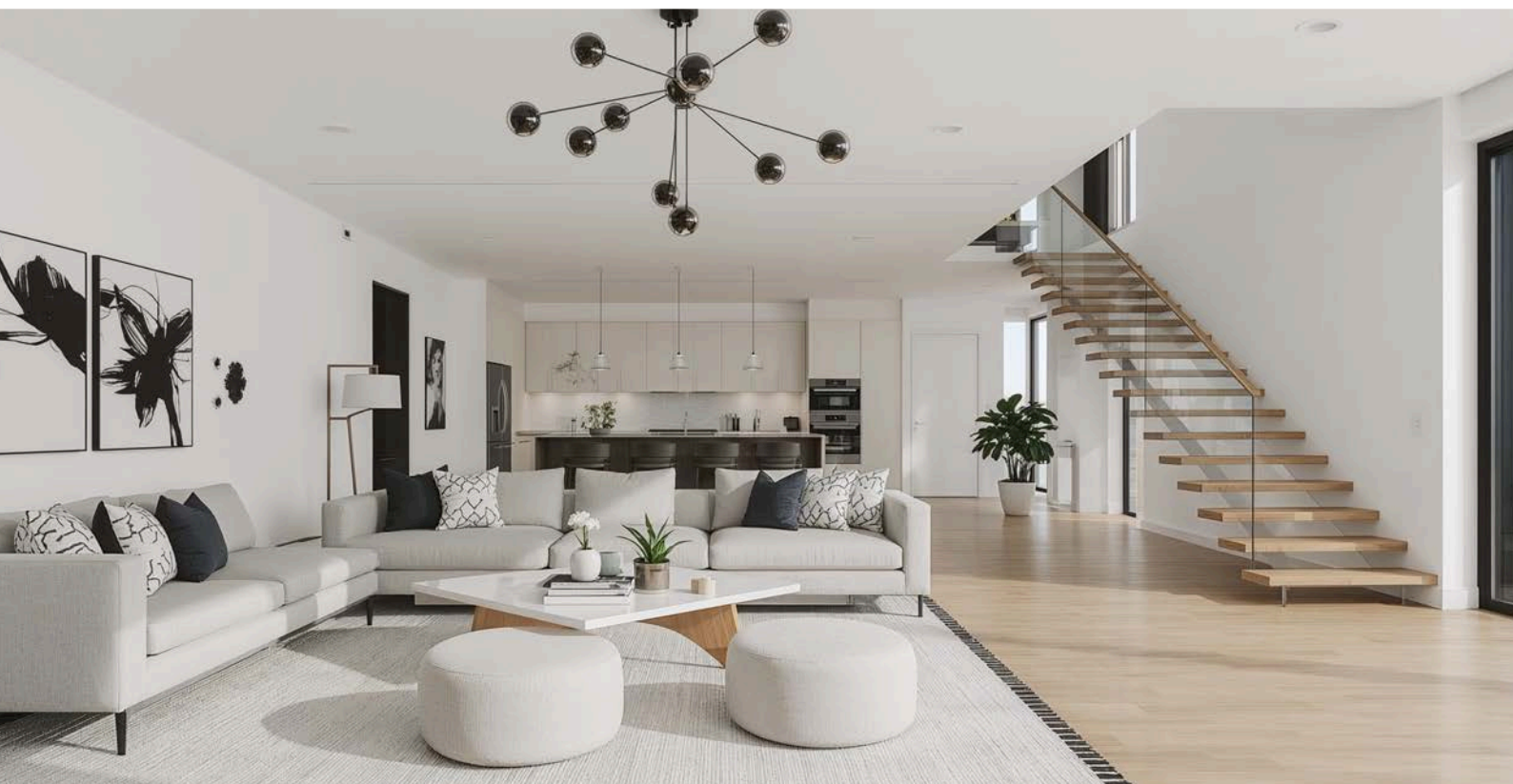
Simple preparations, such as opening curtains, maintaining a comfortable temperature, and ensuring spaces feel clean and uncluttered, can significantly improve buyers' responses.

Buyers also feel more relaxed when they can move through the property freely, without the homeowner present.

This allows them to speak openly, ask questions, and take their time.

When buyers feel comfortable, they stay longer, and the longer they stay, the stronger the connection becomes.

**“The longer a buyer stays,
the more likely they are
to make an offer.”**



DON'T MISS THE RIGHT BUYER

Buyer interest doesn't always happen at convenient times, and the right buyer can appear at any moment.

While open homes create structured opportunities, many serious buyers request private viewings during the week.

These buyers are often highly motivated and ready to act.

Keeping your home consistently well presented ensures that every viewing creates the best possible impression.

Simple habits — such as maintaining tidy living spaces, opening curtains, and keeping key areas clean can make a significant difference.

The best buyer doesn't always come through the first open home.



LET'S POSITION YOUR HOME FOR A PREMIUM SALE

The right preparation and strategy can make a significant difference to your final sale price.

Every home is different, and the right approach depends on your property, your timing, and current market conditions.

I work closely with my clients to position their homes to attract strong buyer interest and create competition, which ultimately drives premium results.

If you're considering selling, I can show you exactly how to prepare and position your home to achieve the best possible outcome.

Scan me



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